

Mama Tried

D **G** **D** **G**
The first thing I remember knowin, was a lonesome whistle blowin
D **G** **A7**
And a younguns dream of growin up to ride
D **G** **D** **G**
On a freight train leavin town, not knowin where I'm bound
D **A7** **D**
No one could change my mind but Mama tried
D **G** **D** **G**
One and only rebel child, from a family meek and mild
D **G** **A7**
My Mama seemed to know what lay in store
D **G** **D** **G**
Spite all my Sunday learnin, Towards the bad I kept on turnin
D **A7** **D**
Til Mama couldn't hold me anymore

[Chorus]

D **G** **D**
And I turned twenty-one in prison doin life without parole
Bm **D** **A7**
No one could steer me right but Mama tried, Mama tried
D **G** **D**
Mama tried to raise me better, but her pleading, I denied
A7 **D**
That leaves only me to blame cause Mama tried

D **G** **D** **G**
Dear old Daddy rest his soul, left my Mom a heavy load
D **G** **A7**
She tried so very hard to fill his shoes
D **G** **D** **G**
Workin' hours without rest, wanted me to have the best
D **A7** **D**
She tried to raise me right but I refused

(Repeat Chorus)